

ALEXSANDRA CAVALCANTI

University of Rochester Rochester-NY, USA

cavalcantialex.github.io acavalca@ur.rochester.edu

EDUCATION

- [2030] Ph.D. in Political Science, University of Rochester
- 2024 Master in Political Science (100/100), Federal University of Pernambuco (UFPE)
- 2022 Bachelor of Laws (92/100), Federal University of Pernambuco

ACADEMIC RECOGNITION

- 2025 Top 5 master's dissertation of the Political Science Department for 2021-2024, UFPE
- 2021 XII Naide Teodósio Gender Studies Award, Pernambuco State Government
- 2021 Best Social Sciences Scientific Initiation, Federal University of Pernambuco

PEER REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

- 2024 Cavalcanti, A. & Nóbrega, Flavianne. "Unveiling the institutional arrangements in the criminalization of indigenous peoples: the logic of the enemy in the case of the Indigenous People Xukuru of Ororubá." *Direito&Praxis*. DOI: 10.1590/2179-8966/2023/72019.

ONGOING PROJECTS

- Rettl, P.; Cavalcanti, A. "Religion, politics, and fairness reasoning: how the Church changes the support for redistribution."
- Cavalcanti, A. "Measuring the Balance of Budgetary Power in Brazilian Executive-Legislative Relations."
- Cavalcanti, A. "Between Benevolence and Corruption: How Transparency in Pork-Barrel Affects Municipal Health."

ACADEMIC AFFILIATIONS

- 2025— Democracy Center Fellowship
- 2026 Research assistant of professor Paula Rettl, Harvard Business School
- 2026 Research assistant of professor Anderson Frey, University of Rochester

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

- 2025 Workshop of Data Visualization on R, offered for the Recife Municipal Government
- 2022-2023 Teacher assistant on Comparative Politics II, supervised by prof. Marcus André Melo, UFPE
- 2022 Teacher assistant on Political Institutions II, supervised by prof. Marcus André Melo, UFPE
- 2022 Teacher assistant on Python Programming for Political Science, supervised by prof. Davi Moreira, UFPE
- 2022 Teacher assistant on Quantitative Methods II, supervised by prof. Davi Moreira, UFPE

GRANTS

- 2025 CAPES Fulbright Ph.D. Scholarship (awarded, declined)
- 2024 Brazilian Association of Political Science, IPSA-USP tuition scholarship (R\$ 3,000)
- 2022-2023 CAPES Full Masters Scholarship (R\$ 50,400)
- 2018-2019 FACEPE Scientific Initiation Scholarship (R\$ 4,800)
- 2018 UFPE Extracurricular Activities Scholarship (R\$ 1,600)

ADDITIONAL QUALIFICATIONS

- 2024 J-PAL LAC Workshop on generation and use of evidence for public policy decision-making tailored to the female population, Recife - Brazil
- 2024 IPSA-USP Summer School on time-series analysis, São Paulo - Brazil
- 2023 SICSS Workshop on computational social sciences hosted by FGV-ECMI, online
- 2023 BITSS Workshop on research transparency and reproducibility hosted by UC Berkeley, Berkeley - United States

PRESENTATIONS

- 2025 *Paper* | Between Benevolence and Corruption: How Transparency in Pork-Barrel Affects Municipal Health, Ronald Coase Workshop on institutional economics, Perugia and Florence - Italy
- 2025 *Invited lecture* | Jurisprudence Research and Scientific Methodology, Recife Law School (FDR), Recife-PE, Brazil
- 2024 *Online poster* | Between Benevolence and Corruption: How Transparency In Pork-Barrel Affects Municipal Health, Latin American PolMeth Meeting 2024 (LAPolMeth)

NON-ACADEMIC POSITIONS

- 2025 Public policy evaluations manager, Recife Municipal Government (PE-Brazil)
- 2023-2024 Data analyst, Recife Municipal Government (PE-Brazil)
- 2017-2022 Researcher of the aSIDH Human Rights Clinic, UFPE
- 2021-2022 Intern on Criminal Law, Pernambuco State Public Prosecutor's Office
- 2019-2020 Intern on Administrative Law, Pernambuco State Court of Law
- 2019 Intern on Consumer Law, Serur & Neueschwander Law Firm

OTHER PUBLICATIONS

- 2024 Cavalcanti, A. "Mensurando o equilíbrio de poder orçamentário das relações Executivo-Legislativo brasileiras." *Masters Dissertation*, Athena Repository.
- 2022 Nóbrega, F., Montanha, C., Cavalcanti, A., Figueiredo, J., Castro, R., Castro, C., Nascimento, A. H., Sousa, L. M., Silva, L. G. M. & Cardoso, B. R. "The Extension Project as Amicus Curiae in the Case of the Curado Penitentiary Complex in the Pernambuco Court of Justice." In: *Transformando vítimas em protagonistas: uma experiência da extensão universitária aSIDH*. Recife: Federal University of Pernambuco Press, UFPE Press.
- 2022 Nóbrega, F., Montanha, C., Cunha, L. E., Silva, E., Melo, M. B., Cavalcanti, A., Figueiredo, J., Castro, R., Castro, C., Nascimento, A. H., Barros, I., Leimig, J. & Cardoso, B. R. "The University's Voice as Amicus Curiae and Its Human Rights Projects in the Brazilian Supreme Court." In: *Transformando vítimas em protagonistas: uma experiência da extensão universitária aSIDH*. Recife: Federal University of Pernambuco Press, UFPE Press.
- 2022 Nóbrega, F., Montanha, C., Cunha, L. E., Barros, I., Cavalcanti, A., Figueiredo, J., Castro, R., Castro, C., Pinto, A. C. A., Leimig, J., Cardoso, B. R. & Nascimento, A. H. "Amicus Curiae of the aSIDH Extension of the UFPE Questioning the 'Marco Temporal' Jurisprudence in the Brazilian Supreme Court." In: *Transformando vítimas em protagonistas: uma experiência da extensão universitária aSIDH*. Recife: Federal University of Pernambuco Press, UFPE Press.
- 2022 Nóbrega, F., Cavalcanti, A. & Leimig, J. "Between Law and Struggle: The Case of the Xukuru People of Ororubá and the Formal and Informal Institutional Arrangements That Made It Difficult and Favored the Promotion of Rights." In: *Transformando vítimas em protagonistas: uma experiência da extensão universitária aSIDH*. Recife: Federal University of Pernambuco Press, UFPE Press.
- 2022 Nóbrega, F., Silva, E., Medeiros, R., Cunha, L., Montanha, C., Andrade, B., Pinto, A., Barros, I., Cavalcanti, A., Figueiredo, J., Castro, R. & Castro, C. "Academic Report Sent to the Inter-American Human Rights Court Before the International Trial in the Case of the Xukuru Indigenous People and Its Members v. Brazil." In: *Democratizando o acesso ao Sistema Interamericano de Direitos Humanos: estratégias para promoção local dos direitos humanos*. Recife: Federal University of Pernambuco Press, UFPE Press.

- 2022 Nóbrega, F., Silva, E., Nascimento, A., Castro, R., Castro, C., Leimig, J. & Cavalcanti, A. “Local Monitoring of the Inter-American Court’s Decision in the Case of the Xukuru Indigenous Community and Its Members v. Brazil After Trial.” In: *Democratizando o acesso ao Sistema Interamericano de Direitos Humanos: estratégias para promoção local dos direitos humanos*. Recife: Federal University of Pernambuco Press, UFPE Press.
- 2022 Nóbrega, F., Barbosa, M. L., Cunha, L., Montanha, C., Andrade, B., Pinto, A., Barros, I., Cavalcanti, A., Figueiredo, J., Castro, R., Castro, C. & Leimig, J. “The Federal University of Pernambuco as Amicus Curiae in the General Repercussion Indigenous Case of the Xokleng People for the Demarcation of Indigenous Lands Throughout Brazil.” In: *Democratizando o acesso ao Sistema Interamericano de Direitos Humanos: estratégias para promoção local dos direitos humanos*. Recife: Federal University of Pernambuco Press, UFPE Press.
- 2022 Nóbrega, F., Cunha, L., Silva, T., Montanha, C., Andrade, B., Pinto, A., Barros, I., Cavalcanti, A., Figueiredo, J., Castro, R. & Castro, C. “Report on Advances and Constructive Efforts to Respect and Guarantee the Rights of LGBTI People in the Americas Sent by UFPE to the Inter-American Commission on Human Rights.” In: *Democratizando o acesso ao Sistema Interamericano de Direitos Humanos: estratégias para promoção local dos direitos humanos*. Recife: Federal University of Pernambuco Press, UFPE Press.
- 2022 Nóbrega, F., Cunha, L., Silva, T., Montanha, C., Andrade, B., Pinto, A., Barros, I., Cavalcanti, A., Figueiredo, J., Castro, R. & Castro, C. “Contribution of the aSIDH as a Federal University of Pernambuco’s Extension Project to the Monitoring Forum of the Curado Penitentiary Complex: Unprecedented Measures to Monitor the Decisions of the Inter-American Court of Human Rights.” In: *Democratizando o acesso ao Sistema Interamericano de Direitos Humanos: estratégias para promoção local dos direitos humanos*. Recife: Federal University of Pernambuco Press, UFPE Press.
- 2020 Cavalcanti, A. “Indigenous and Quilombola Collective Property in the Brazilian Judiciary After the Xukuru People’s Case.” *Conference Paper*, XI Congresso da ABraSD (Online).
- 2020 Cavalcanti, A. “Patchwork: The Definition and the Legal Apparatus of Collective Property in Brazil.” In: *Dimensões dos direitos humanos e fundamentais (vol. 2)*. Rio de Janeiro: Pembroke Collins, PDF.
- 2018 Cavalcanti, A. “The Incapacity of Indigenous Individual Capacity in Brazil.” *Conference Paper*, IX Congresso da ABraSD, São Paulo-SP, Brazil.

SKILLS

- R, Python, L^AT_EX, SQL

LANGUAGES

- Portuguese (mother-tongue) & English (fluent) & Spanish (reading proficiency)

LICENSES

- 2022 Lawyer exercise license, Brazilian Order of Lawyers (OAB)